ENTANGLEMENT

Four areas of technology really got a steroid shot between 2022 and 2030, due to the Chinese strike. All of these cumulatively made up for the loss of China at the global stage.

AI: AI grew by leaps and bounds because money was thrown at the field. In fact, the coffers really opened up for scientists and researchers in almost all fields that had anything even remotely to do with manufacturing. Spending was almost like wartime, where winning is the only thing that matters. While no official figures exist, it's estimated that a whopping 2 trillion USD was spent in the past 10 years on AI research alone!

Robotic manufacturing: One of the biggest benefits of smarter AI is the ability for robotic manufacturing to become more and more efficient and fault tolerant. In just the last two years leading up to 2030 five all-robot factories have been brought online – two by Germany and three by the US. Four of them are self-driven car plants, one specifically churning out Teslas, which the German government bought from Elon Musk in 2025. The fifth is an experimental factory that's been set up to try and produce general robots that can perform multiple tasks around the house. After unveiling a truly scary hulk of a robot that the public absolutely hated, US Robotics (named after the fictional company in Asimov's Robot series) has now redesigned all robots to be the size of pygmy females, and frail looking. Currently a status symbol, it's rumoured that the metal and hard plastics of the pygmy robots are set to be replaced by normal, human-sized silicone skin and bone like structure, making robots just as brittle and fragile as us humans.

Localised manufacturing: While large robotic only plants rule mass production of cars and robots, localised production using more purpose built robots under the supervision of humans or working alongside humans in the pre-2020 assembly style have really taken off, but at a much smaller scale. The huge drop in price of specialised robots happened when AI started designing and manufacturing the robots with minimal human oversight needed. This made it far easier for just about anyone to scale up small businesses to medium size. Apart from technology, most other manufacturing is localised and caters to the local subculture's tastes.

Additive manufacturing: Once called 3D printing, new methods of additive manufacturing were discovered, which sadly put an end to all large format hardware and spare part stores. The dream of a maker revolution was finally realised with everyone now owning at least a basic home manufacturing kit, capable of producing all the small spares you need. And for larger spares, they're all available with 1 hour delivery by drone thanks to Amazon, the world's largest courier service.

> **The globalization of putting everything where production is the most efficient — that is over.**
>
> – Jörg Wuttke, Chairman, European Union Chamber of Commerce
> https://dgit.in/dglbzn

A RED LETTER DAY

While we are focussing on the good that's happened in the world ever since that notable day in 2020 when China went on strike, we should also look at a few areas that paved the way for the success we see around us.

Innovation restarted: While it seemed that innovation had stagnated for the decade between 2010 and 2020, it took off again in a big way in this decade. This was largely due to UN funding of colleges and people being able to follow their passions, with assured jobs waiting for them when they finished. College life was turned into a 4 year competition to out innovate one another, which led to nearly every large company worth mentioning today, including US Robotics.

Patents: One of the biggest advantages of China walling itself up was that there was no reason to adhere to patent regulations for the patents it owned. And boy did it own a lot of patents. In order to prevent any squabbling, all patents owned by China until 2020 were made free and open source for the rest of the world to use. This resulted in such a huge jump forwards in technology, that the world mandated that all patents awarded to people while they still studied in universities were to be open source, as all public higher education universities in every country were funded by the UN, in order to truly make use of the intellect of smartest people in the world. Science and technology is now on the brink of discoveries previously thought impossible. Including understanding the real shape of the universe and the nature of time, to developing general AI that is about as smart as a grade 1 human child with 100 IQ.

De-globalisation: With local manufacturing taking off, only raw materials were being transported for manufacturing of everyday items and consumables. Technology was still centralised to the Silicon Hills of South-East Asia, and in pockets in Europe and America, but everything else was localised. Google was broken up by country, with shareholders needing to belong to that country. Thus the Google wars of 2026, which pitted countries against one another in an attempt to research a general AI search algorithm capable of reading content like a human and classifying it. Google India eventually won out, because the sheer diversity of languages in India allowed them to master the art of polylingual AI.

Waste disposal: In the post China world, with prices skyrocketing, and e-waste being worth its weight in silver, countries got pretty good at dealing with their e-waste, which also led to innovations in dealing with general waste as well. Not only was all plastic used now biodegradable, when dumped in the sea it turned into nutritious fish food, which brought back hundreds of species of fish from the brink of extinction.

Overall, the world was a far better place than we thought it would turn out to be, because there's nothing like a global crisis to bring countries with common goals together.